

Financially Sovereign Academy

Correctional and Reentry Program

Budgeting & Emergency Savings

Assessment & Survey Packet

Version 0.1 (provisional) · 2026-07-04

Provisional pilot-ready draft. External counsel review pending. Not for final facility distribution until legal/privacy feedback is reconciled.

Described as pilot-ready, never proven or validated. No outcome or recidivism claims.
Not legally approved. Source & Claims Ledger held at v0.2.

Pre/Post Assessment: Budgeting & Emergency Savings (v0.2)

Program: Correctional and Reentry | Version: v0.2 (assessment, post-audit) | Date: 2026-07-02 | Status: Needs Dalia review Supersedes v0.1 (kept as history). Applies all approved audit fixes including the mandatory High privacy fix; change list in end matter. Companion to learner workbook v0.2 and facilitator guide v0.2. Measures decision-making, not memorized definitions. Same form used pre and post (matched). All dollar amounts illustrative. Paper-first, pencil-only, black-and-white, no calculators, hand math only, state-neutral, dual-track.

Part A: Instructions for staff

When to give the PRE: before any Session 1 teaching. The pre takes its own 15 minutes IN ADDITION to Session 1's 90 minutes. Either schedule a 105-minute first session or give the pre in a separate sitting beforehand. **Do not cut Session 1 content to fit the pre.**

When to give the POST: at the end of Session 4, after the module close (or at the capstone, if the facility runs one; use the same timing for everyone in a cohort).

After the pre: collect it and move on. Never review, discuss, or correct answers after the pre. The course is the teaching. The answer key stays with staff until after the post.

Privacy rules (these are different from the workbook):

- Workbook pages are never collected. The assessment is the ONE paper that is collected, and learners are told that plainly (collection script below).
- **No names on the form. Learners choose their own code** and write it on both the pre and the post so the two can be matched. Read this instruction aloud: "Pick a code only you would recognize, and one you will still remember in a month. Do not use your name. Do not use your ID number."
- Never grade publicly. Never read scores aloud. Never post results. Never compare learners to each other in any setting.
- With learner-chosen codes, individual results are not attributable by the facility and are never shared with supervision officers or used in any case decision.
- **If your facility requires facility-assigned IDs on the forms, the promise above is no longer true, and you must not make it.** Use this truthful alternate when introducing the assessment: "This form carries your facility ID, so the facility can connect it to you. Scores are still never announced, never posted, and never compared in this room. If that changes what you want to write, that is your call, and skipping questions is allowed." Raise the ID requirement with the program contact; the goal is learner-chosen codes.
- **Form handling:** completed forms leave the facility with the facilitator the same day, or are stored under a written agreement. The facility implementation guide (MOU) owns this requirement; confirm it exists before the first administration.
- **If your facility cannot honor these privacy rules, do not administer the assessment.** Run the course without it.

Collection script (say this before collecting, both sittings): “This is the one paper I collect in this whole course, and here is exactly why: it tells us whether the class teaches what it promises. No name, just your code. Nobody announces scores. Nobody ranks you. It is a report card for the class, not for you.”

Low literacy: read the entire assessment aloud to the whole group, question by question, at a steady pace, every time, for everyone. This is the default, not an accommodation, so nobody is singled out. Learners mark answers on their own paper. A private scribe is allowed for anyone who asks.

Skips: any question may be skipped. Skipped questions are tracked separately, never scored as wrong (see Part F).

Part B: Learner-facing instructions

This is not a test of you. It is a measure of the class: it tells us whether these sessions teach what they are supposed to teach. That is why we ask the same questions before and after.

- There are no trick questions. Pick the answer you would actually choose.
- If none of the answers fits what you would really do, write yours next to the question. Real answers count.
- Estimates and best guesses are fine.
- You can skip any question.
- No name goes on this paper. Write your code at the top: one only you would recognize, and one you will remember in a month. Not your name, not your ID number. Nobody announces scores, ever.
- All amounts are examples, not real prices.

Part C: Decision questions (same form, pre and post)

Q1. It is your first week out. You have \$80 left for the week. Which one gets protected first?

- A) New clothes that feel like you
- B) The bus fare to Thursday’s required check-in
- C) Paying back a friend who keeps calling about \$40

Q2. Marcus has \$60 for the whole week. What is his strongest first move?

- A) Spend nothing until something forces him to
- B) Write down the order things get paid before spending anything
- C) Buy everything he needs on day one so it is handled

Q3. One-step math. Pay this week is \$240. Housing share is \$100. Phone is \$20. Transit is \$40. How much is left after those three? Work one step at a time.

\$240 - \$100 = \$_____ then - \$20 = \$_____ then - 40 = **_____**

Q4. Three weeks of pay: \$300, then \$180, then \$260. Which number should the weekly plan be built on?

- A) \$300, to stay motivated
- B) \$180, the smallest week
- C) The average of the three

Q5. Your job starts in two weeks. Rent share is due on the 1st. Your first paycheck lands about the 5th. What is the strongest move?

- A) Say nothing and hope it works out
- B) Talk to whoever is owed BEFORE the 1st, and offer a specific amount and a specific date
- C) Get a loan against the paycheck the day rent is due

Q6. A cousin lends you \$100 and says: "Pay me back first, before your rent, before anything." What is the hidden cost of this loan?

- A) The interest
- B) The repayment order: it pushes the rent behind a personal debt
- C) That he might need it back suddenly

Q7. You have \$250. Rent share of \$180 is due Friday. Tonight a relative you love asks for \$150 for an urgent bill. Which answer does the LEAST damage?

- A) Give the \$150 tonight and sort the rent out later
- B) Give a smaller amount now with a date for the rest, and protect the rent
- C) Promise the full \$150 next month without checking next month's numbers

Q8. A court-related fee is due this week and your money does not cover it and food. What is the strongest FIRST move?

- A) Skip the fee quietly and hope nobody notices
- B) Contact the office that charges it, early and in writing, ask what options exist, and keep a copy
- C) Cover the fee with a payday loan so it is handled

Q9. You need \$250 fast. Which option puts the thing that EARNS your money most at risk?

- A) Asking your employer about an advance
- B) Pawning your work tools
- C) A payday loan due in full from the next check

Q10. A text from an unknown number says: "PRE-APPROVED \$500! No credit check, no ID needed, click tonight!" What is the strongest sign this is not a real offer?

- A) The dollar amount is too big

- B) It asks for nothing from you and pushes you to act fast
- C) It arrived on a weekday

Q11. Three things happen the same week. Mark each one: **E** = emergency now, **C** = coming anyway (should be planned, not treated as a surprise), **P** = pressure dressed up as an emergency.

- ___ The car that gets you to work will not start
- ___ A winter coat for December, and it is October
- ___ Your cousin wants \$100 tonight for something he will not explain, and keeps calling

Q12. You are not sure what happens if a supervision payment is missed. What is the strongest move?

- A) A friend who is also on supervision told you what happened to him; go with that
- B) Ask the office or legal aid, in writing, and keep the answer
- C) Decide it is probably fine and wait to see

Part D: Confidence questions (same form, pre and post)

Circle one number for each. 1 = not at all confident, 2 = a little, 3 = somewhat, 4 = mostly, 5 = very confident.

How confident are you that you can...	1	2	3	4	5
C1. Make a money plan for your first week, even with very little	1	2	3	4	5
C2. Plan around pay that changes from week to week	1	2	3	4	5
C3. Ask early, in writing, when a bill or obligation may not fit	1	2	3	4	5
C4. Spot a fast-money offer that costs more than it gives	1	2	3	4	5
C5. Make an emergency plan even when savings are at zero	1	2	3	4	5
C6. Have a backup move ready when money gets tight	1	2	3	4	5

Part E: Answer key (staff only)

Q	Strongest answer	Why it is strongest	Acceptable alternates	Scoring note
Q1	B	Staying legal protects everything else; missing a check-in costs more than bus fare	none	1 pt

Q	Strongest answer	Why it is strongest	Acceptable alternates	Scoring note
Q2	B	The order is the decision; a written order beats both freezing (A) and burning it all (C)	none	1 pt
Q3	\$140, \$120, \$80	One-step chain subtraction, the floor-grid skill	final \$80 with slips in middle boxes still earns the point	1 pt for \$80
Q4	B	Plan to the floor, not the average; the \$180 week is the truth number	none	1 pt
Q5	B	Predictable gap = negotiable gap; the early ask with number and date is the cheapest bridge	none	1 pt
Q6	B	Informal loans price in repayment order and relationship, not interest; C is a real risk but not the named trap in this offer	none	1 pt

Q	Strongest answer	Why it is strongest	Acceptable alternates	Scoring note
Q7	B	Partial with a date protects rent and relationship; least damage, not perfect	A written-in honest “no plus real alternative help” (per the Part B write-in invitation) also earns the point	1 pt
Q8	B	Early, written, right office is the process skill; A is silence, C converts one problem into two	none. NOTE: this question tests the ask, never which bill “wins”; do not accept or discuss rankings	1 pt
Q9	B	The tools are the income source; pawning them bets the earner itself. C costs heavily but does not put the earner on the table; that distinction IS the lesson	none	1 pt
Q10	B	Needs-nothing plus manufactured speed are the tells; real offers can be compared, fakes only need a click	none	1 pt

Q	Strongest answer	Why it is strongest	Acceptable alternates	Scoring note
Q11	E, C, P (in listed order)	Emergency vs coming-anyway vs pressure; the third item's markers are the refusal to explain and the repeat calling (the tactic), never the fact that family is asking	reasonable argued alternates do not earn the point but merit no correction beyond the key	1 pt per item, 3 pts
Q12	B	When stakes are high, guessing alone can make the damage worse; one person's outcome is not your rule; routing beats folklore	none	1 pt

Knowledge/decision total: 14 points.

Part F: Scoring guide (staff only)

- **Knowledge/decision score:** count points, max 14. Record pre and post per code.
- **Skips:** never scored as wrong. Track separately and report “answered X of 14.” For the pre/post comparison, exclude any item skipped on either sitting from that learner’s change score.
- **Confidence change:** post rating minus pre rating per statement (range -4 to +4); average the six for one confidence-change number.
- **Never use scores to shame, rank, gate, or report on an individual.** Scores exist to improve the class and to describe, in aggregate, how decision scores and confidence changed.
- **This is a program-built measure, not a validated scale.** In any report or grant language, describe it as “a pre/post decision-and-confidence measure built for this curriculum.” Never call it validated.

- **Optional aggregate reporting for facilities/funders:** cohort average pre score, average post score, average change; average confidence change; number of participants; average items answered; nothing identifying. Report wording must never promise or imply outcome guarantees (no recidivism claims, no financial-outcome claims). The honest sentence is: “Participants’ decision scores and self-rated confidence changed by X on average.”
- A learner whose score goes down is not a failure case; small cohorts move on small numbers. Look at cohort patterns, not persons.

Part G: Alignment table

Q	Session	Skill	Ontology concept	Workbook scenario
Q1	1	Week-one triage	Triage order; protect what earns/keeps you legal	S01 / S02
Q2	1	Order before spending	The order is the decision	S01
Q3	2	One-step chain subtraction	The floor (mechanics)	S13 grid
Q4	2	Plan to the floor	The floor as truth number	S13
Q5	2	Gap bridging	Income timing; the early ask	S03
Q6	2/3	Informal-loan pricing	Family pressure; hidden trap	S03 (cousin)
Q7	3	Family ask, least harm	Least harm; number and date beat a maybe	S04
Q8	3	Official obligation process	The early written ask; routing; never rank	S16
Q9	4	Risk to the earner vs cost	Protect-the-earner; true cost	S07 / S19
Q10	4	Fraud pause	Manufactured urgency; information asymmetry	S19 Part B

Q	Session	Skill	Ontology concept	Workbook scenario
Q11	4	Emergency definition	Emergency vs coming-anyway vs pressure (tactic, not relationship)	S4 close (E/C/P sort)
Q12	3/4	Route, do not guess	When stakes are high, do not guess alone	S16 / guide script 9
C1-C6	1-4	Self-efficacy on the module spine	Slow the damage / protect the next step / ask early / keep a backup move ready	whole module

90-Day Follow-Up Survey: Budgeting & Emergency Savings (v0.2)

Program: Correctional and Reentry | Version: v0.2 (survey, post-audit) | Date: 2026-07-02 | Status: Needs Dalia review Supersedes v0.1 (kept as history). Applies all approved audit fixes and both owner decisions; change list in end matter. Companion to assessment v0.2 and implementation guide v0.2; inherits their privacy architecture in full. Optional for learners, always. Paper-first, pencil-only, black-and-white, plain language. Measures what learners tried, never what the program “caused.”

Part A: Staff instructions

When: about 90 days after the final session (a 60 to 120 day window is fine; use the same window for a whole cohort). Distribution goes through the reentry partner named in the MOU, never through supervision reporting channels.

No-trusted-partner rule: if there is no trusted reentry partner, do not distribute the survey through supervision channels. Supervision channels are never a fallback, even with good intentions. The only alternative is a facility-based day-90 sitting, for learners still at the facility. If there is no partner and no sitting, do not run the survey. The program still runs fine without it.

Return logistics: the partner returns completed forms to the facilitator or program contact, sealed, within two weeks of collection.

Who scores: the program’s scorer is the person named in MOU item 7, the same person as the assessment scorer unless the MOU states otherwise. Nobody else sees individual forms.

Vocabulary (use these words): counted means the survey was returned. Answered means the learner filled in at least one question. Reports must show distributed, returned, and answered. Avoid “scored” in anything learner-facing; use “answered.”

Privacy: identical to the assessment. Learner-chosen code, optional even then. No names, no ID numbers. No list linking codes to anyone. The no-exception rule applies: individual answers are never shared with officers, supervision staff, case managers, employers, housing programs, or funders. Aggregate reporting only. Requests for individual answers are logged and refused (implementation guide, section 2). Same-day custody applies; **survey forms are destroyed (shredded) within 60 days of receipt**, with the same destruction log. If these rules cannot be honored, do not run the survey.

The survey is optional. Say so plainly. Nobody is chased, penalized, or noted for skipping it. A blank survey handed back is a valid response; it counts as returned, not answered.

Read-aloud: where the survey is given in a group, read it aloud, whole group, question by question, same as the assessment. Where it is mailed or handed off individually, the partner offers help privately.

Never coach answers. Hand it over, step back.

Do-not-overclaim rule (for staff and funders): this survey reports what respondents say they tried in the months after the class. It does not and cannot show that the class caused anything. People who answer are not a random sample of the class. The honest sentence for any report is: “Of those who responded, X said they tried [behavior].” Never use survey results to claim recidivism effects, financial outcomes, or program-caused change. Never present respondent counts as if they were the whole cohort.

Part B: Learner-facing survey (1-2 pages)

Before you start. This survey is optional. It helps us make the class better for the people after you. No name goes on it. If you did the class assessment, you can write the same code you used then; if you skipped that or forgot it, leave the code blank; your answers still count. **Your individual answers go only to the program’s scorer, are never shared with anyone, and are destroyed within 60 days of being counted.** Nothing here goes to officers, case managers, employers, housing programs, or anyone deciding anything about you. There are no wrong answers, and “not yet” is a normal answer; life after release is not a test.

My code (optional): _____

Since the class ended, have you tried any of these? Mark one per row.

Did you...	Yes	Tried it, hard to keep up	Not yet	Did not need it
1. Make a money plan for a week or a month				
2. Figure out your floor (plan around your smallest week)				
3. Ask early about a bill, fee, or obligation before it was late				
4. Put a question or agreement in writing before saying yes				

Did you...	Yes	Tried it, hard to keep up	Not yet	Did not need it
5. Avoid or delay a fast-money option (payday loan, advance app, pawn, title loan)				
6. Use a backup move instead of spending (food pantry, asking for time, free resource)				
7. Use the local resource sheet from class (call or visit anything on it)				
8. Make or update your zero-dollar emergency plan (the wallet card)				

How confident do you feel now? Circle one number each. 1 = not at all, 5 = very.

	1	2	3	4	5
C1. Making a money plan with whatever amount you have	1	2	3	4	5
C2. Asking early when a bill or obligation may not fit	1	2	3	4	5

	1	2	3	4	5
C3. Handling a money shock without fast-money offers that could cost me more later	1	2	3	4	5

What got in the way? Mark any that made money harder these past months. This is about the situation, not about you.

- ☐ Income was smaller or less steady than expected
- ☐ Housing costs or housing changes
- ☐ Fees or obligations stacked up
- ☐ Family needed money
- ☐ An emergency hit early
- ☐ Paperwork or ID problems
- ☐ Something else: _____
- ☐ Nothing major got in the way

One question in your own words (optional): What is one thing from the class you actually used, or one thing the class should teach differently?

Please do not write names, case details, or anything that identifies you or someone else. Tell us about the class.

Thank you. Every answer, including “not yet,” makes the class better for the next group.

Part C: Aggregate reporting note (staff)

Three-numbers rule: every report states distributed, returned, and answered, together. Blank surveys count as returned, not answered. No exceptions.

Report only: those three numbers, counts per answer option, average confidence ratings, most common barriers, and anonymized themes from the open question (never quoted in a way that could identify anyone; if a quote could only be one person, do not use it). The honest framing sentence: “Of those who responded, X said they tried [behavior].” No causal claims, no outcome claims, no individual data, ever.